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20 Motion Graphic Designer Interview Questions and Answers

Common Motion Graphic Designer interview questions, how to answer them, and sample answers from a certified career coach.



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Are you a motion graphics designer with an upcoming job interview? If so, chances are you’re feeling the pressure to make sure you shine and stand out from other candidates.

The good news is that there are some common questions asked in motion graphic design interviews. By preparing answers to these questions ahead of time, you can give yourself a leg up over the competition and show off your skills as a top-notch motion graphic designer. Read on for some of the most frequently asked motion graphic design interview questions—and how to answer them.

☰ COMMON MOTION GRAPHIC DESIGNER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- ✓ What is your experience with motion graphics software such as Adobe After Effects, Cinema ...
- ✓ Describe a time when you had to create an animation from scratch.
- ✓ How do you approach creating storyboards for animations?

EXPAND +

1. What is your experience with motion graphics software such as Adobe After Effects, Cinema 4D, or Maya?

Motion graphics designers use specialized software to create dynamic visuals that can be used in video, broadcast, and digital media. Knowing how to use these tools is essential to being a successful motion graphics designer, so it’s important that interviewers ask this question to get an idea of the applicant’s experience and proficiency with these programs.

How to Answer:

To answer this question, you should talk about the motion graphics software that you are most familiar with. Talk about any projects you have completed using the software and how long you have been using it. If you don’t have much experience with the tools mentioned in the job description, emphasize your willingness to learn and any other relevant skills or experience you may have.



though less extensively. I'm confident that I can quickly ramp up my skills in either program if needed. Additionally, I have a strong understanding of motion graphics principles such as timing, pacing, and storytelling which will help me create successful visuals no matter what software I'm working with."

2. Describe a time when you had to create an animation from scratch.

Motion graphic designers are expected to be able to take basic concepts and turn them into compelling visuals. This question is designed to determine how well you can go from concept to finished product in a timely manner. The interviewer will want to know about your creative process, how you manage your time, and how you handle feedback from a client or supervisor.

How to Answer:

Be prepared to go into detail about your experience with each software you've used, such as how long you've been using it and what projects you've worked on. You should also be able to explain the steps you take when creating motion graphics and how you troubleshoot any issues that arise. Demonstrate your ability to work quickly and efficiently by giving examples of time management strategies you use. Finally, emphasize your willingness to accept feedback from clients or supervisors in order to create the best product possible.

Example: *"I recently completed a project for ABC Design Agency where I had to create an animation from scratch. To start, I researched the company's brand and created a storyboard that outlined the main points of the video. Once approved by the client, I used Adobe After Effects to bring the motion graphic to life. Throughout the process, I was in constant communication with the client to ensure that their vision was being met. I also took advantage of my experience with 3D software such as Cinema 4D to add depth to certain parts of the animation. In the end, I was able to deliver a high-quality product within the given timeline and exceeded the expectations of the client."*

3. How do you approach creating storyboards for animations?

Motion graphics are used to convey complex stories and concepts in an engaging and visually compelling way. To do this, motion graphic designers must have a strong command of the principles of animation as well as the tools and techniques used in the process. This question is designed to gauge your understanding of the process and get a sense of how you approach the task.

How to Answer:

Start by explaining that storyboarding is an important step in the process of creating a motion graphic. Explain how you use it to plan out the animation, determine the pacing and timing of each scene, and create a visual reference for yourself and your team. Talk



how you take these sketches and refine them until they are ready to be animated.

Example: *"I approach creating storyboards for animations by first breaking down the script or concept into individual scenes. I then draw sketches of each scene on paper or using specialized software, such as Storyboarder. As I go through this process, I'm thinking about how to convey the story in an engaging way and make sure that the visuals are effectively communicating the message. Once I have a rough sketch of all the scenes, I refine them until they are ready to be animated. This allows me to create a visual reference for myself and my team so we can stay focused on the goal of producing a high-quality motion graphic."*

4. Are you familiar with the principles of animation and how they can be used to create engaging visuals?

Motion graphic design is a complex field that requires a thorough understanding of animation principles and techniques. An interviewer will want to know if you have the necessary skills to create compelling visuals that will engage viewers. By asking this question, they can assess your knowledge and experience in this area and determine if you're the right candidate for the job.

How to Answer:

To answer this question, you should be prepared to talk about the principles of animation and how they can be used in motion graphic design. You should also discuss any experience that you have with using these principles in your work. Make sure to provide specific examples of projects where you applied animation principles to create engaging visuals. Additionally, mention any software or tools that you've used to create motion graphics. This will demonstrate your technical proficiency and show the interviewer that you understand the fundamentals of motion graphic design.

Example: *"I have a deep understanding of animation principles and how they can be used to create engaging visuals. I've worked on numerous motion graphic projects, using software such as After Effects and Premiere Pro to create dynamic videos with special effects and transitions. For example, in my most recent project for XYZ Corporation, I applied the principles of squash and stretch to add realism to the character animations. Additionally, I used keyframing techniques to create smooth camera movements and make sure that the visuals were visually appealing."*

5. Explain your understanding of color theory and how it applies to motion graphics design.

Color theory is an important concept in motion graphics design, as it helps to create visuals that are eye-catching and effective. By asking this question, the interviewer is looking to see how well you understand the fundamentals of design and how you use color to create an impact. Your answer should demonstrate your knowledge of the basics of color theory, as well as how you use it to create motion graphics that are visually appealing and impactful.



Start by explaining the basics of color theory, such as the three primary colors (red, yellow, and blue) and how they are used to create secondary and tertiary colors. Then explain how you use this knowledge in your motion graphics design work. For example, you can talk about how you use contrasting colors to draw attention to certain elements, or how you use analogous colors to create a sense of harmony and balance. Finally, provide an example of how you have applied these concepts to a project you've worked on.

Example: *"I understand the basics of color theory, including how primary colors combine to create secondary and tertiary colors. I also understand how different combinations of colors can evoke certain emotions or reactions from viewers. For example, I often use contrasting colors in my motion graphics work to draw attention to important elements or messages. I also use analogous colors to create a sense of harmony and balance within a piece. Recently, I was asked to create an animated explainer video for an online course. In this project, I used reds and oranges to bring energy to the visuals and illustrate the importance of the topic being discussed."*

6. Tell me about a project that required you to work with 3D models and textures.

Motion graphic design jobs often require the designer to create 3D models and textures. This question is a way for the interviewer to assess your skills in this area. They want to know if you understand how to use 3D modeling and texture mapping software, if you can create realistic lighting and textures, and if you are familiar with the tools and techniques needed to create a high-quality 3D animation.

How to Answer:

To answer this question, you should provide a brief overview of a project that required you to work with 3D models and textures. Describe the software used, the techniques employed, and any challenges you faced while working on the project. Be sure to emphasize your knowledge of 3D modeling and texture mapping, as well as how you overcame any difficulties encountered during production. Finally, mention the end result of the project and any feedback or recognition you received for it.

Example: *"In my previous role as a motion graphic designer, I worked on a project that required me to create an animated 3D model of a product. To do this, I used Autodesk Maya and Adobe Photoshop to design the textures and apply realistic lighting. I also had to use ZBrush for sculpting details and Substance Painter for creating detailed materials. It was a challenging process, but in the end, the client was extremely pleased with the results. They even featured the animation on their website and social media channels."*

7. How do you ensure that the motion graphics you create are optimized for different platforms and devices?



you're aware of the different types of platforms and devices that motion graphics can be used on and that you understand the importance of optimizing them for each platform or device.

How to Answer:

For this answer, you should emphasize your technical knowledge and proficiency when it comes to optimizing motion graphics for different platforms and devices. You can talk about the specific software programs that you use to optimize your designs, such as Adobe After Effects or Cinema 4D, and how you adjust the settings in these programs to make sure that the motion graphics are optimized for each platform or device. Additionally, you can mention any other techniques that you use to ensure that the motion graphics look great no matter what platform or device they're viewed on.

Example: *"I understand the importance of optimizing motion graphics for different platforms and devices. I use a variety of software programs, such as Adobe After Effects and Cinema 4D, to adjust settings that ensure my designs look great no matter where they're viewed. Additionally, I always make sure to test out the motion graphics on various platforms and devices before delivering them to the client, so I can be certain that everything looks perfect. That way I know that the motion graphics will look great no matter what platform or device they're being viewed on."*

8. What strategies do you use to make sure your animations are visually appealing and effective?

Motion graphics are a combination of art and science. They have to look good, but also be optimized for the medium they're being used in. From color choice to timing, the interviewer will want to know that you understand the nuances of motion graphic design and how to optimize your animations for their intended audience.

How to Answer:

Start by talking about the motion graphic design process you use. This should include researching the target audience, understanding their needs and preferences, and choosing colors and fonts that will be visually appealing to them. Talk about how you structure your animations for maximum impact—you want to make sure they're not too long or too short, and that the timing is just right. Finally, discuss any optimization techniques you may use, such as compressing files or adjusting frame rates, to ensure that your animations look great no matter what device they're viewed on.

Example: *"I always start by researching the target audience and understanding who they are and what they're looking for. I then use this information to choose colors and fonts that are visually appealing to them. When it comes to structuring my animations, I want to make sure they're not too long or too short and that the timing is just right. I also use optimization techniques such as compressing files or adjusting frame rates to ensure that my animations look great no matter what device they're viewed on. All of these strategies help ensure that my animations are visually appealing and effective."*



Motion graphics are an increasingly popular way to create visuals for a variety of media, including virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR). It's important for potential employers to know if you have experience with these types of projects in order to determine whether you will be able to work on their projects. Additionally, it gives the interviewer an indication of your familiarity with the cutting edge of motion graphics technology.

How to Answer:

If you have experience with VR or AR projects, explain in detail the types of projects you've worked on and how you used motion graphics to create visuals for them. If you don't have direct experience with these types of projects, talk about any related skills that you do have (such as 3D modeling) and explain how they would be applicable to working on a VR or AR project. Also mention any resources you have used to stay up-to-date on the latest trends in motion graphics technology.

Example: *"I have had the opportunity to work on several VR and AR projects in the past. Most recently, I created 3D models and motion graphics for a virtual reality game. Additionally, I have been actively researching and staying up-to-date on the latest trends in motion graphics and VR/AR technology. I am familiar with the tools and techniques used to create visuals for these types of projects, and I am confident that I could bring my skills to your team and help create successful projects."*

10. Describe a time when you had to troubleshoot a technical issue related to motion graphics.

Motion graphics is a highly technical field, and you should be able to demonstrate that you know how to diagnose and solve technical issues as they arise. Interviewers will want to know that you're not only creative but also technically adept. Showing them an example of a time when you faced a technical challenge and overcame it will help them get a better sense of your skills and experience.

How to Answer:

Technical issues are a common challenge for motion graphic designers, so the interviewer wants to know how you handle these types of situations. Start by describing the issue in detail—what was happening and what were the symptoms? Then explain the steps that you took to identify and solve the problem. Be sure to include any research or collaboration with colleagues that you did along the way. Finally, describe the solution that you found and how it resolved the issue.

Example: *"I recently encountered a technical issue with a motion graphic project that I was working on. The project was for a client, and it involved creating a complex animation with multiple layers and effects. The animation was running very slowly, and I suspected it was due to a software glitch. I did some research and consulted with my colleagues to identify the possible causes. After some experimentation, I was able to*



was installed, the animation ran smoothly and the project was finished on time.”

11. Do you have any experience working with video editing software such as Adobe Premiere Pro or Final Cut Pro?

Motion graphic design requires a certain level of technical skill, and a potential employer will want to know that you have a good handle on the software they use. This question is a great way to get a sense of your working knowledge and skill level with regards to the tools of the trade.

How to Answer:

Be prepared to discuss your experience with video editing software. Talk about any projects you’ve worked on that required the use of these programs, as well as any courses or certifications you have in this area. If you don’t have much direct experience, focus on your ability to learn quickly and adapt to new technologies. You can also mention any other relevant experiences such as working with animation software or 3D modeling programs.

Example: *“I have quite a bit of experience working with video editing software. I’ve used Adobe Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro on a number of projects, both in a professional setting and in my own personal projects. I’m also certified in Adobe After Effects and have a good understanding of the basics of 3D modeling software. I’m confident that I can use my experience and knowledge to create compelling motion graphics for your projects.”*

12. How do you handle tight deadlines while still producing high-quality work?

Motion graphic design, like any other creative work, requires a lot of focus and attention to detail. However, in a lot of work environments, tight deadlines can be the norm. The interviewer wants to know that you can come up with creative solutions to produce quality work even when you have limited time. They also want to know that you can prioritize tasks and manage your time efficiently.

How to Answer:

You should be prepared to discuss how you can balance quality and speed when it comes to motion graphic design. Talk about techniques that you use to prioritize tasks, stay organized, and manage your time effectively. You can also mention any tools or software that you use to streamline the process, such as project management software or task automation tools. Finally, emphasize that you understand the importance of delivering high-quality work even under tight deadlines.

Example: *“I’m used to working under tight deadlines and understand the importance of delivering high-quality work even when there isn’t much time. I prioritize tasks based on the deadline, and I’m well-versed in project management software such as Trello and*



when there are tight deadlines.”

13. What techniques do you use to keep track of multiple versions of an animation?

Motion graphics designers have to be able to keep track of multiple versions of a project. This could involve different versions of the same animation, as well as versions with different animations. This is a critical skill for any motion graphics designer, and the interviewer wants to know that you’re up to the task.

How to Answer:

To answer this question, you should describe the techniques that you use to keep track of multiple versions. This could include using version control software like Git, or naming conventions for different versions. You might also discuss how you organize files and folders so that it’s easy to find the right version quickly. Finally, don’t forget to mention any tools that you use to help automate the process, such as automated backups or scripts.

Example: *“I use a combination of techniques to keep track of multiple versions of an animation. I use version control software like Git to keep a record of the changes I make to the project, and I also use naming conventions for different versions so that I can easily tell them apart. I also organize my files and folders so that it’s easy to find the right version quickly. To help automate the process, I use automated backups and scripts to ensure that I always have the latest version available.”*

14. How do you stay up to date with the latest trends in motion graphics design?

Motion graphics design is a field that is constantly evolving. Trends change quickly and keeping up with the newest techniques, tools, and styles is essential for staying competitive in the industry. The interviewer wants to know that you are actively engaging in the motion graphics community and are willing to stay current with the latest advancements in the field.

How to Answer:

You should be able to demonstrate that you are actively engaging in the motion graphics community. Talk about any online forums, blogs, or other resources you use to stay up-to-date on new trends and techniques. You can also mention any conferences or workshops that you have attended or plan to attend in the future. Additionally, if you have taken any courses related to motion graphics design, this is a great opportunity to highlight your dedication to staying current in the field.

Example: *“I make it a priority to stay up to date with the latest trends in motion graphics design. I’m an active member of several online forums, where I can connect with fellow motion graphics designers and learn about the latest techniques and tools. I also follow*



industry. Finally, I'm currently taking an online course to deepen my understanding of motion graphics design."

15. What strategies do you use to collaborate effectively with other designers and developers?

Motion graphic design is a collaborative effort, and you need to be able to work with other designers, developers, and other stakeholders to create the best product. The interviewer wants to know that you can communicate and work effectively with others, and that you understand the importance of collaboration and teamwork in motion graphic design.

How to Answer:

Start by talking about how you approach collaboration. Do you prefer to take charge and lead the project, or do you like to discuss ideas with other members of the team before making decisions? Talk about the strategies that you use to ensure everyone's opinions are heard and respected, such as setting up regular check-ins or having a "no idea is a bad idea" policy. You can also talk about any tools or technologies that you use to facilitate collaboration, such as video conferencing software or task management systems.

Example: *"I believe that collaboration is key to any successful motion graphic design project. I like to start by setting up regular check-ins with the team to ensure that everyone is on the same page and that everyone's ideas are heard. I also make sure to use tools like Slack and video conferencing software to facilitate communication between team members. I'm always open to feedback and I think it's important to be as flexible as possible when it comes to making changes to the project. I also like to create a timeline for the project with clear deadlines so that everyone is aware of their responsibilities."*

16. How do you determine which elements should be animated and which should remain static?

Motion graphic designers are responsible for creating visually stimulating designs that bring to life the story they're trying to tell. An interviewer will want to know if you're able to make those decisions in an efficient and creative way. It's important to be able to think on your feet and come up with solutions that will help you create the best product for your clients.

How to Answer:

The best way to answer this question is to talk through an example of a project you've worked on recently. Explain what elements you decided to animate and why, as well as which ones you chose to keep static and why. This will show the interviewer that you have the ability to think critically about design decisions and come up with creative solutions.



subtle animations in the text elements to draw the viewer's attention to key points. I also kept the main logo static so that it would stand out against the dynamic background. I chose this approach because it allowed me to create a visually appealing motion graphics piece that was still easy to digest and comprehend."

17. What methods do you use to test the usability of your animations?

Motion graphics designers are expected to create animations that are visually appealing, but also easy to use. Usability testing is an important part of the design process and can help identify any potential problems in the animation before it is released. This question gives the interviewer an idea of how you approach the design process and your commitment to creating the best possible product.

How to Answer:

Your answer should focus on the methods you use to test the usability of your animations. These may include user testing, A/B testing, or other types of testing. You should also mention any techniques you use to ensure that the animation is easy to understand and navigate, such as using clear labels, providing an intuitive design, and making sure all elements are clearly visible. Additionally, discuss how you incorporate feedback from users into your designs to make them more usable.

Example: *"I always start with user testing to make sure my animations are usable. I recruit participants who match my target audience, then give them tasks to complete using the animation. This helps me identify any potential problems and refine the design before it is released. I also use A/B testing to compare different versions of the animation and see which performs better. I also make sure to use labels that are easy to understand, provide an intuitive design, and make sure all elements are clearly visible. I also take feedback from users into account to make sure the animation meets their needs."*

18. How do you balance creative expression with client expectations?

Motion graphic designers play an important role in helping businesses accurately convey their brand messages. But the nature of the job often means you'll have to work with clients who have their own ideas about how the work should look. It's important to be able to communicate your ideas while also taking into account the needs of the client. This question can help the interviewer understand how you manage this delicate balance.

How to Answer:

To answer this question, you should emphasize your ability to be flexible and open to feedback. Talk about how you've worked with clients in the past to understand their vision and expectations for a project before starting work. Explain how you use that



satisfaction.

Example: *"I always start a project by having a conversation with the client to understand their goals and expectations. I'm also open to feedback throughout the process, so I can make sure the work is meeting their needs. I like to create a few different options for the client, so they have a range to choose from. I also try to be creative and push the boundaries a bit to create something that stands out. I think the key is to find the balance between creative expression and client expectations, and I've had a lot of success in doing that."*

19. What challenges have you faced when creating complex animations?

Motion Graphics Designers often have to create complex animations that require a lot of technical know-how. Interviewers want to know if you can handle the challenge of creating these animations and if you have the skills to overcome any problems that may arise. They also want to know what techniques you use to ensure the animation is as smooth and accurate as possible.

How to Answer:

Talk about the technical challenges you've faced when creating complex animations, such as working with a limited timeline or dealing with large files. Explain what techniques and processes you use to ensure accuracy and smoothness in your work. You can also talk about any troubleshooting strategies you have for when something doesn't go according to plan. Finally, make sure to emphasize how you take pride in delivering quality results even under tight deadlines.

Example: *"I've faced plenty of challenges when creating complex animations, from working with tight timelines to dealing with large files. I use a variety of techniques to help ensure accuracy and smoothness in my work, such as creating an animatic before I start animating, testing the animation multiple times throughout the process, and using layers to break down the animation into manageable chunks. I also have a variety of troubleshooting strategies that I use if something doesn't go according to plan. I take pride in delivering quality results, even when faced with tight deadlines."*

20. Describe a time when you had to explain a concept to a non-technical audience.

Designers often need to present their work to stakeholders or clients who may not be familiar with the technical side of the project. Being able to explain complex concepts in a simple way is an important skill for a motion graphic designer to have. By asking this question, the interviewer is trying to get an understanding of how you communicate and how well you are able to explain technical concepts to a non-technical audience.

How to Answer:



terms that your audience could understand. Talk about any visuals or analogies you used to help explain the concept in an easy-to-understand way. Finally, discuss what the outcome was and how well it was received by the audience.

Example: *“I was working on a motion graphic project for a client that was unfamiliar with the technical concepts involved. I had to explain the concept of motion graphics to them, which can be tricky to explain to someone who isn’t familiar with the field. To do this, I drew a simple diagram of the concept and used analogies to help them understand it. I also provided examples of other motion graphic projects I had done in the past to show them what the final product would look like. The client was very pleased with my explanation and ended up being very excited about the project.”*

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